



CHAPTER ONE



Match strategy to situation



Chapter Summary

In this chapter, the author emphasizes the importance of matching leadership strategies to the specific context of the organization. Using the STARS model, which outlines five business situations—start-up, turnaround, accelerated growth, realignment, and sustaining success—leaders can tailor their approach effectively. Each situation presents unique challenges and opportunities that demand different leadership styles and strategies. The ability to diagnose one's STARS portfolio is crucial for understanding the landscape and facilitating meaningful change. Ultimately, adapting leadership styles based on situational needs leads to better outcomes.



Understanding the Situation

To lead effectively, start with a clear understanding of your current organizational condition. Recognize the unique challenges that come with the situation you are facing. This clarity is vital to tailoring your approach and strategy for success.

"Diagnostic clarity leads to effective strategies."

Introducing the STARS Model

The STARS model categorizes situations into five key areas: start-up, turnaround, accelerated growth, realignment, and sustaining success. Each category has its own sets of challenges and requires tailored leadership approaches for success.

"The right strategy arises from recognizing the situation."

Start-Ups: Building from Scratch

In start-up scenarios, leaders focus on establishing capabilities such as team and infrastructure. This phase is marked by excitement and potential, but can also suffer from a lack of direction as clarity and structure are still being formed.

Turnarounds: The Urgent Call

Turnarounds demand swift and decisive action; leaders must identify and tackle deep-rooted issues quickly. The focus is on restoring functionality rather than building new structures, often under tremendous pressure.

Accelerated Growth: The Challenges of Scaling



As organizations grow rapidly, the challenge lies in scaling effectively while maintaining core values. Leaders need to implement strong systems and processes without losing the organization's essential culture.



Realignment: Revitalizing Strengths

In realignment situations, the main task is to rejuvenate the organization and create urgency for change. Acknowledging warning signs and inciting action while maintaining strengths will be key.

Sustaining Success: No Room for Complacency

Sustaining success is a balancing act of innovation and excellence. Leadership focuses on continual growth, mitigating complacency, and adapting to emerging challenges in a stable environment.



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Diagnosing Your STARS Portfolio



Understanding your specific STARS situation is paramount. This diagnostic exercise involves categorizing aspects of your responsibilities to manage the challenges and identify opportunities more effectively.

Rewarding Different Successes



Evaluating success varies across situations.
Leaders must recognize contributions uniquely in
turnarounds and realignments where success might
not always be apparent, but significant nonetheless.



Recap

- "Diagnostic clarity leads to effective strategies."
- "The right strategy arises from recognizing the situation."
- "Growth requires discipline and structured implementation."
- "Recognize the need for revitalization before it's too late."
- "Success is not an endpoint; it's an ongoing journey."



Thank You

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